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Graduate Recruitment Team

Macquarie Group

Ropemaker Place, 28 Ropemaker Street

London EC2Y 9HD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Commodities and Global Markets Graduate Programme in London, with a particular interest in commodities, particularly gas and power. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Macquarie's recognition as Natural Gas/LNG House of the Year at the 2026 Energy Risk Awards matters to me because European gas is the market my dissertation studies.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously; my lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 were built on disciplined bet sizing and a strict bankroll rule.

Macquarie's Commodities and Global Markets business stands out to me because it combines physical and financial expertise in gas, from the long-term LNG offtake agreements it signed with Texas LNG and AMIGO LNG in 2025 to the risk-management solutions it offers clients, and it was named Natural Gas/LNG House of the Year at the 2026 Energy Risk Awards. My dissertation measures how storage and news drive TTF volatility, and I would like to learn how those same drivers shape the hedges and prices Macquarie offers its clients.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan